

JANELLEVISSARARIVAL360EDIT

Travel Radio Australia and we're at the magnificent Arrival 360 event in Brisbane and I have one of the organisers here, Janelle Visser and Janelle, welcome to the program. Thank you for having me. Now Janelle, tell us about Arrival.

It's a fantastic event for the tourism industry from across the world. They come here to Brisbane and you have other events internationally as well. Yeah, so Arrival does events around the world for the tours, activities and attractions sector of travel experiences.

We bring together experienced providers from all over the place as well as tech companies and distributors and everyone who kind of works in this really fun experiences space that we like to call the best part of travel. You do events here in Brisbane and tell us about a few of the other destinations where you have these events. So this is the first event that we've done in Australia here in Brisbane and we're super excited to be here.

We do events around the world. The two key ones that we do every year are a North American event and a Europe event and so those change locations usually every year or every other year. And whereabouts are you in Europe? So the last event that we did in Europe was in Valencia in Spain, Valencia.

We've been in Berlin as well and next year we're going to Bilbao in Europe. And in the USA? We usually alternate from east to west and so last year we were in Washington DC, which was interesting. Next year we're going to be in Spokane, Washington on the west coast, which is close to me.

I'm based in Vancouver, Canada. And what happens at these conferences for those who have never attended one? How do people react and interface with each other here? For anyone who's been to like a large travel conference, it's quite different. It's usually a smaller group.

This one we have just over 300 at the Brisbane one. We're hoping to grow it. The U.S. event is usually around 800 to 1,000 people.

Europe's 700 to 800 people. So it's a much smaller scale than some of these huge industry events, but it's focused specifically on this sector, the things to do, tours, activities and attractions sector. And so there is an educational component.

We have a lot of programming in large theater sessions, as well as more like workshop style breakout sessions, where we really get into it on a lot of the stuff that operators are dealing with. So everything from marketing to how do you connect to distribution channels, to like the types of technology that can help you run your business better. And what's happening in the industry? Arrival does a lot of research.

We do a lot of industry research, consumer research about the travel sector, experiences sector. And so what does that mean and where are we going as an industry comes up a lot as well. And yeah, it's just, it's a, it's a time that people get together in this industry to meet each other.

It's such a cool community of really passionate people and kind of find our way together through what's next. Now, I attend a lot of these events, especially huge events like WTM World Travel Market in London. And while they're fantastic, they're so big and they, you know, you couldn't possibly get around to see all of them.

These, these smaller events are really great because you can get around to see a lot of, a lot more people very quickly. Yeah. One of the things, one of the feedbacks that we get from people is that they can really connect with each other here in like a more personal way.

It doesn't feel like a, it's not a buy sell event where there's a lot of vendors that are trying to hard sell you on things. It's really about relationships and meeting people. And, you know, you can meet people who, who do the same thing as you in a different part of the world, but they're not a competitor.

Cause if you run a bike tour here and someone else runs a bike tour halfway across the planet, you're not competitors, but you can share information and you can share experiences and you can help each other out. And so there's a lot of that kind of stuff that happens in the, in between spaces, in the conversations and at the parties and during coffee and over lunch. And that's a lot of the highlight for people is really that community feeling that you get at a smaller event like this.

And Janelle Visser from Arrival360, your first time to Australia. Tell us a bit about your impressions. Oh, well, this is actually my fourth time.

And my first time in Australia was in 2017. And I was very enamored with meat pies and the abundance of roundabouts. Well done, Australia.

It's the little things, it's the little things. Yeah. Yes, our homemade meat pies are pretty good.

They really are chunky. And that's what I find overseas. When you try a meat pie, it's nothing like the ones here in Australia.

And any other impressions about Australia? Oh, well, of course, you know, as a Canadian, I actually feel pretty comfortable and at home in Australia. It's a pretty fun place to be. I've had some really great travel experiences here, some really great tours and excursions and beautiful views, beautiful ocean, surfing.

The list is so long. But the one thing I wish I could bring back to Canada is you guys have proper ginger beer here. And I really appreciate that.

And that's honestly one of the things that I'm most excited about every time I return to Australia,

because I can't get it in Canada. Especially the Bundaberg. The Bundaberg ginger beer is really famous overseas.

Well, I don't want to get in trouble for picking a brand, but I'll tell you a funny story. When Team Arrival got here initially, our hotel was across the street from a sign that said 4X. And one of my co-workers was very concerned that we were in a bad part of town.

And she didn't realize that 4X was a beer. And we were like, oh, this is like one of those places. But what's the 4X for? And then, you know, we found out it, oh, it's a beer brand and they have ginger beer too.

So that was kind of a funny cultural learning. That is hilarious. Yes, that's funny.

What's the next step for Arrival? It's Arrival with one R, not two. So yes, Arrival 360, if you want to look it up online. And what's your next event? Where are you off to next? Our next event is in Spokane, Washington, the west coast of the US.

We are hoping to be back in Australia next year. We're hoping to grow this event. So tell all your friends.

Yeah. Yeah, if you're in the travel industry, Arrival 360, I would highly recommend it. And it is such a lovely, relaxed, informal, smaller event where you can really get to know people.

And I'm really impressed as well. Janelle Bisseff, thank you so much for being with us on Travel Radio Australia. And we hope that, you know, the entire industry in Australia books on to meet all your fabulous people.

Thank you. And if you want to learn more or get more of a sense of what we're about, check out Arrival.travel. We have a newsletter. We have a lot of research online.

Video recordings from the event will be available. And also we have a podcast, the best part of travel podcast, all about this sector. And what is the actual website again? Arrival.travel. That's A-R-I-V-A-L.

Arrival with one R dot travel. Also with one R. Thank you Janelle for being on the program. Thank you for having me.